

JSS 3 NIGERIAN HISTORY – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 3: FEDERALISM IN NIGERIA

1. Meaning of Federalism

Federalism is a system in which governmental power is shared between a central (federal) government and component units (states and, in Nigeria, local governments). Each level has defined powers under the constitution.

2. Nigerian Federalism

Nigeria is a federation of 36 states and the Federal Capital Territory (Abuja), with local government areas. The constitution allocates exclusive, concurrent and residual powers. Resource control, revenue allocation and state creation have been long-standing issues.

3. Challenges

- Over-centralisation and weak states in practice
- Disputes over revenue sharing and oil resources
- Ethnic and regional competition
- Corruption and capacity gaps at all levels
- Security challenges that cross state boundaries

4. Summary

Federalism aims to unite diversity under one country while sharing power. Nigerian federalism faces serious challenges that reform and good governance seek to address.

End of Topic 3